Day 77 - Ilse Hanel, Warder, Cemetery Road

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 101 · Lion's Head Provincial Nature Reserve

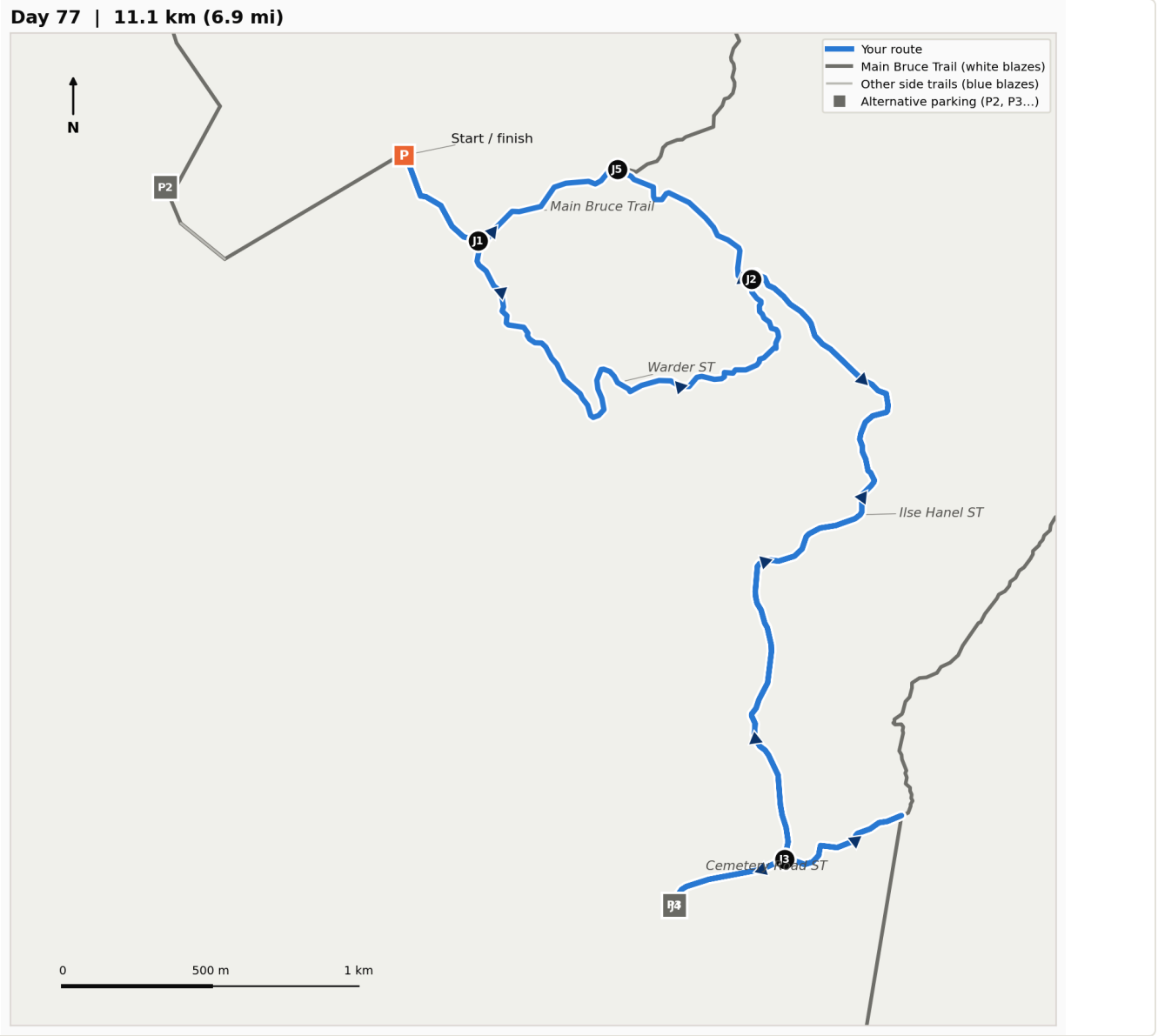
11.1 km / 6.9 mi	~4.0 h	6.3 km new	205 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): McCurdy Drive Municipal Parking Lot (off of Moore St.): Online booking is required - visit lionsheadparking.ca. No RVs or trailers permitted. Do not block access or park on Moore St. Google Maps. **Paid: $20 for 4 hours or $30 full day · book ahead** · online booking (ParkPass via lionsheadparking.ca); Booking required May 15-Oct 15 (full day 24 h ahead); free shuttle from Arena lot ($15/day) summer weekends

Navigate: import *day77_hike101.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Ilse Hanel Side Trail (3.8 km); Warder Side Trail (2.0 km); Cemetery Road Side Trail (0.4 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** The McCurdy Drive lot is small. Book online at lionsheadparking.ca (required mid-May to October 15, at least 24 hours ahead; $20 for 4 hours or $30 a day). No RVs or trailers, and do not park on Moore St. In summer the municipality suggests the Lion's Head Arena lot and free shuttle.
- **Road walking:** The main trail starts and ends on the road shoulder through Lion's Head village. Keep Zappy close.

- **Main Bruce Trail from McCurdy Drive:** This is the busiest stretch in the reserve, with lots of technical rock and stretches that run close to the cliff edge. Wear sturdy boots and keep Zappy on a short leash near the drop-offs.
- **Warder, Ilse Hanel & Cemetery Road Side Trails:** The Warder and Ilse Hanel Side Trails are blue-blazed and form part of the reserve's perimeter loop. No detailed terrain descriptions were found, but the reserve's back trails are described as wildflower-rich woodland with karst landforms.
- **Facilities:** There are no visitor facilities in the reserve beyond the washrooms near the McCurdy lot. Carry water.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Lion's Head Harbour: The best parking is on Phillip Forbes St, right on the Trail by the beach map	Paid (amount not confirmed)	0.0	1070 m	
P3	Parking area outside the Lion's Head Provincial Nature Reserve gate, accessible from Bruce... map	Free · book ahead	5.5	0 m	Cemetery Road

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: McCurdy Drive Municipal Parking Lot (off of Moore St.): Online booking is required -.... Head south-east on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail. The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.4	0.3	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Warder Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
2.4	1.5	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail goes off on your left.)
5.0	3.1	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Cemetery Road Side Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail goes off on your left.)
5.4	3.4	J4: End of the Cemetery Road Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (Parking area outside the Lion's Head Provincial Nature Reserve gate, accessible from...). Turn around and retrace your steps.
5.8	3.6	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail, heading east. (the Ilse Hanel Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.) This is a short excursion (about 980 m in all): walk the whole Ilse Hanel Side Trail, including the short loop or branch near its end (see the map), and come back to this junction.
6.8	4.2	J3: Junction. Turn right to stay on the Ilse Hanel Side Trail, heading north. (the Cemetery Road Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
9.4	5.8	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Ilse Hanel Side Trail, heading west. (the Warder Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
10.1	6.3	J5: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
10.6	6.6	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the Warder Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
10.9	6.8	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
11.1	6.9	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Northern Bruce Peninsula, Fastest Known Time, 10Adventures and the Great Lakes Sea Kayaking Association.